

APPLICATION ·
EMIRATES

TECHNICAL PRODUCT OWNER - AIRLINE ENGINEER, MRO &
DIGITAL AIRCRAFT.

Philipp Hilbert. *Technical Product Owner, Airline Engineering & MRO.*

Positioning, ten years owning complex, regulated backlogs end-to-end, from defence AI and public-sector analytics to insurance and payments, ready to bring that rigour to Emirates' MRO and Digital Aircraft domain.

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§ WHY EMIRATES

Emirates sits at the intersection of operational complexity and digital ambition that very few organisations can match: the MRO and Digital Aircraft domain is not a support function, it is the engineering backbone of the world's largest international airline, where a missed dependency in a sprint backlog can ripple into airworthiness implications. The posting is explicit about SAFe at scale (circa 50+ teams), PI Planning, and the need for a TPO who can hold backlog quality across feature work, Technical Debt, NFRs, and BAU simultaneously, that is precisely the multi-layer prioritisation challenge I have navigated across defence, insurance, and public-sector programmes. *That is exactly the environment where structured, outcome-oriented product ownership compounds.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not shipped product inside an airline MRO or airworthiness-regulation environment before. The regulatory vocabulary, airworthiness directives, component lifecycle tracking, CAMO workflows, is new to me as a domain. What I do bring is deep experience translating complex, safety-adjacent regulatory constraints (German health data law, EU AI Act, defence procurement rules) into acceptance criteria and backlog priorities, so the learning curve is a domain mapping exercise, not a first encounter with regulated operational systems.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, paired development and code review
- **Cursor / VSCode**, context-aware editing
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, structured analysis and edge-case generation
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder decks and PI demo prep
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Framer**, design-heavy prototypes

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, SQL, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers, built alone from zero.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protecting both sides until commitment; WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface.
- LLM agents across the full funnel so a single operator runs day-to-day matching and follow-up.
- Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; backlog and prioritisation owned entirely by the founder.
- Demonstrates the same zero-to-one product muscle needed when a TPO has to drive innovation ideas through an organisation with no existing playbook.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT EMIRATES

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow PI Planning artefacts and existing team backlogs in the MRO and Digital Aircraft domain, map current dependency chains, and identify where acceptance criteria are under-specified or Technical Debt is untracked.

WEEK 2

Refine, prioritise, align.

Run a structured backlog refinement session with each team, tightening story content and acceptance criteria against the upcoming PI, and surface untracked NFRs and BAU capacity sinks to the TPM.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, iterate.

Own the PI demo contribution, define success metrics for prioritised features, and establish a feedback loop so BAU iterations are proposed and scoped within real team capacity rather than aspirational velocity.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Emirates Group IT Recruitment Team,

The Technical Product Owner role in the Airline Engineering, MRO and Digital Aircraft domain is the kind of position I have been preparing for through thirteen years of product ownership in complex, regulated environments. Emirates' explicit requirement for a TPO who can hold backlog quality across feature work, Technical Debt, non-functional requirements, BAU, and ceremonies simultaneously, while contributing to PI Planning in a scaled SAFe environment, maps directly to the multi-layer backlog discipline I have applied at Rohde & Schwarz, the Bundesagentur für Arbeit, and EMIL Group.

At Rohde & Schwarz I was the Product Manager for an internal AI and data platform supporting the FCAS European defence programme. I owned the backlog across a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists, ran Scrum ceremonies in Jira and Confluence, and championed GitOps delivery with ArgoCD that reduced rollout time from days to 30 minutes.

Critically, I redirected the entire product strategy based on workflow instrumentation: the beautiful UI-first approach recorded exactly zero clicks; the developer-code-first path increased pipeline runs by 200%. That is the kind of evidence-based prioritisation a TPO in a high-stakes domain needs to make credible trade-offs between feature velocity and technical rigour.

At EMIL Group I restructured an 18-person delivery organisation that was losing both its senior engineers and client trust. I formed three lean teams with their own leads, reduced attrition from near-total exodus to a single departure, and shipped the Claims Center from concept to production. The acceptance criteria and story sign-off discipline I built there, ensuring every story was prepared on time, refined with the whole team, and prioritised in alignment with adjacent backlogs, is the same discipline the Emirates posting describes as the TPO's core accountability.

My education reinforces the fit: I hold a Diplom-Wirtschaftsingenieur (Industrial Engineering and Management, equivalent to a Master's degree) from Technische Universität Berlin, with a specialisation in Logistics. The combination of engineering rigour, operational systems thinking, and hands-on product delivery is the profile the MRO domain demands. I also bring e-Commerce product delivery experience from the AOK ITSCare Shopware migration, where I owned backlog refinement, user stories, and acceptance criteria for a procurement platform serving roughly 20,000 employees.

I am an EU citizen, hold no visa sponsorship requirements in the EU, and am genuinely willing to relocate to Dubai, the Emirates posting is a positive fit on location, not a compromise. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background translates into the MRO and Digital Aircraft context.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager and Product Owner with 13 years of ownership in regulated industries, defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, and payments. Equally fluent in backlog discipline and technical infrastructure; at home in SAFe environments with PI Planning, agile release trains, and cross-team dependency management. Joins Emirates to bring structured, outcome-oriented product thinking to the Airline Engineering, MRO and Digital Aircraft domain.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product Ownership: user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, sprint review, retrospective, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI (program increment) planning, WIP limits.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support, e-Commerce platform delivery.

SDLC and Delivery Practices: GitOps rollout and rollback with ArgoCD, CI/CD, regression and end-to-end test automation, containerised environments, release gating, branching and merging strategy, defect-to-fix and cycle time as product metrics.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management, cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, Django, SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, evaluation loops, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI & DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

GitOps delivery with ArgoCD cut rollout from days to 30 minutes; workflow instrumentation drove a 200% increase in pipeline runs; led 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence across the FCAS European programme.

**BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR
ANALYTICS 2023-2024**

Integrated test automation into Jenkins, introduced Dagster and dbt to cut data-update time by 75%, migrated bare-metal to containers, and carried a full UI relaunch and ETL migration in parallel; Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut roadmap to top 10% of features against agreed success measures; user acceptance rose more than fivefold. Implemented CGM/KIS interface reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured 18-person delivery org into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week.

**SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL &
PAYMENTS 2021-2022**

Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning; POS and forecourt systems.

**BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT DATA
PLATFORM 2021**

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

**AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE E-
COMMERCE 2019-2020**

Migrated legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira. Still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end across two locations.

**WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE CLINICAL
NETWORK 2017-2018**

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER & PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero-to-one two-sided B2B marketplace; LLM agents across the funnel; SQL-based funnel and conversion analysis.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER & PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Owned backup, restore/checkpoint, and data-encryption product architecture; shipped a three-layer product installing in under two minutes. Later Chair of the Board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO & CFO · NANOTECHNOLOGY & AGRICULTURE 2018-2021

Took fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER & CFO · FINTECH P2P PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built mobile group-based P2P payments from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native (C2). English, C2.

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